Psalm 5 — Окаянне, убогыи человече!

“O wretched, miserable man!”

IPA pronunciation sheet · sung in the Russian Church Slavonic tradition · text: 16th-century Russian penitential verse

Text with stress

Окая́нне, убо́гыи челове́че! Век твои́ конча́ется, и коне́ц приближа́ется, а Суд стра́шеныи гото́вится. Го́ре тебе́, убо́гая ду́ше! Со́лнеце ти есть на за́пади, а дне при ве́чери, и секи́ра при ко́рени. Ду́ше, ду́ше, почто́ тле́ющими пече́шися? Ду́ше, вострепещи́, ка́ко ти яви́тися Созда́телю своему́, и ка́ко ти пи́ти сме́ртеную ча́шу, и ка́ко ти трьпе́ти смра́дныя ефио́пы и ве́чныя му́кы, о́то нея́ же, Христе́, моли́твами ро́жешая Тя изба́ви ду́ша на́ша.

Line-by-line IPA

1. O wretched, miserable man!

Окая́нне,	убо́гыи	челове́че!
[oka'janʲːe]	[u'bo.gʲi.i]	[tɕelo'vʲetɕe]

2. Your age is ending, and the end draws near,

Век	твои́	конча́ется,
[vʲek]	[tvo.'i]	[kon'tɕajetʲesʲa]
и	**коне́ц**	**приближа́ется,**
[i]	[ko'nʲets]	[prʲibʲlʲi'ʐajetʲesʲa]

3. and the terrible Judgment is being prepared.

а	Суд	стра́шеныи	гото́вится.
[a]	[sut]	['straʂenɨj]	[go'tovʲitsa]

4. Woe to you, miserable soul!

Го́ре	тебе́,	убо́гая	ду́ше!
['gorʲe]	[tʲe'bʲe]	[u'bogaja]	['duʂe]

5. Your sun is in the west, and the day is at evening,

Со́лнеце	ти	есть	на	за́пади,
['solnʲetse]	[tʲi]	[jestʲ]	[na]	['zapadʲi]
а	**дне**	**при**		**ве́чери,**
[a]	[dnʲe]	[prʲi]		['vʲetɕerʲi]

6. and the axe is at the root.

и	секи́ра	при	ко́рени.
[i]	[sʲe'kʲira]	[prʲi]	['korʲenʲi]

7. O soul, O soul, why are you troubled over perishing things?

Ду́ше,	ду́ше,	почто́	тле́ющими	пече́шися?
['duʂe]	['duʂe]	[potɕ'to]	['tlʲejuɕːimʲi]	[pʲe'tɕeʂɨsʲa]

8. O soul, tremble — how will you appear before your Creator,

Ду́ше,	востре́пещи́,	ка́ко	ти
['duʂe]	[vostrʲepʲe'ɕːi]	['kako]	[tʲi]
яви́тися	**Созда́телю**	**своему́,**	
[ja'vʲitʲisʲa]	[soz'datʲelʲu]	[svoje'mu]	

9. and how will you drink the cup of death,

и	ка́ко	ти
[i]	['kako]	[tʲi]
пи́ти	**сме́ртеную**	**ча́шу,**
['pʲitʲi]	['smʲertʲenuju]	['tɕaʂu]

10. and how will you endure the foul dark spirits and eternal torments,

и	ка́ко	ти	трьпе́ти	смра́дныя
[i]	['kako]	[tʲi]	[trʲ'pʲetʲi]	['smradnɨja]
ефио́пы	**и**	**ве́чныя**	**му́кы,**	
[jefʲi'opɨ]	[i]	['vʲetɕnɨja]	['mukʲi]	

11. from which, O Christ, through the prayers of her who bore You,

ото́	нея́	же,	Христе́,
['oto]	[nʲe'ja]	[ʐe]	[xrʲis'tʲe]
моли́твами	**ро́жешая**	**Тя**	
[mo'lʲitvamʲi]	['roʐeʂaja]	[tʲa]	

12. deliver our souls.

изба́ви	ду́ша	на́ша.
[iz'bavʲi]	['duʂa]	['naʂa]

Notes on this text

- **Syllable count in this setting.** Schnittke sets *убо́гыи* on four notes (у-бо-гы-и) and *твои́* on two (тво-и), so the final *и* is sung as its own syllable: [u'bo.gʲi.i], [tvo.'i]. The general rule below — final -ыи = one syllable [ɨj] — is overridden here by the underlay.

- **Khomonic forms in this text** (sung with the extra vowel): кончáетеся (= кончáется), приближáетеся (= приближáется), стрáшеныи (= стрáшный), Сóлнеце (= сóлнце), смéртеную (= смéртную), рóжешая (= рóдшая), óто (= от).
- **Сóлнеце:** the л is sounded [l] (unlike modern Russian *солнце*, where it is silent).
- **трьпéти:** written with ь, so the soft r carries its own light syllable — [trʲ'pʲetʲi]. If your chant source vocalizes it, sing терпéти [tʲer'pʲetʲi].
- **Окая́нне:** double н sung long and soft [nʲː]. -ся / -тся endings: [sʲa]; готóвится [go'tovʲitsa].
- **ефиóпы** (“Ethiopians”) is the traditional image for demons; initial е = [je].
- **Worth checking against your source:** дýша нáша would usually be дýши нáша ['duʂɨ 'naʂa]; зáпади is transcribed as written (cf. зáпаде).

Pronunciation conventions

Tradition. Russian Church Slavonic singing pronunciation: every unstressed vowel is sung pure (okanye — *о* stays [o], *е* stays [e]; no Russian vowel reduction). Stress is marked ' before the stressed syllable and with an acute on the Cyrillic.

Extra vowels are sung. Spellings such as *Солнеце, страшеныи, смертеную, прекрасеная, земеныхо* are the “khomonic” (раздельноречие) forms of znamenny chant, in which lost yers are vocalized as full syllables. They are transcribed as written, with the stress staying where it falls in the ordinary word.

Consonants. ʲ = palatalized (“soft”). *г* = [g] (including endings *-аго/-его*, never [v]). *ч* [tɕ], *щ* [ɕː], *ш* [ʂ], *ж* [ʐ], *ц* [ts] (always hard), *х* [x], *ы* [ɨ]. Word-final voiced consonants devoice as in Russian (*Суд* [sut]).

Archaic кы / гы. Older spellings *кы, гы* are read as soft [kʲi], [gʲi] in present-day church practice (an older, harder [kɨ] is also heard among Old Believers).

Final -ыи / -ии / -ои = [ɨj] / [ij] / [oj], one syllable, unless your setting deliberately gives the [i] its own note.

а	о	у	ы	и	е	я	ю
[a]	[o]	[u]	[ɨ]	[i]	[je / ʲe]	[ja / ʲa]	[ju / ʲu]
ч	**щ**	**ш**	**ж**	**ц**	**х**	**г**	**ь**
[tɕ]	[ɕː]	[ʂ]	[ʐ]	[ts]	[x]	[g]	[ʲ]